

LONGBOWMAN'S KIT

Some well-equipped archers, usually those retained by a nobleman, wore mail coats and helmets. Others wore padded, quilted coats, but many wore no protective clothing at all. A longbowman's job was to rain down death from a distance and when the fighting got too hot for him, he usually ran for safety or relied on the protection of the men-at-arms. If, however, they had to fight, longbowmen often carried a short sword such as a falchion and a small round shield or buckler. When there were spoils for the taking on a battlefield strewn with the bodies of enemy knights, they were quick to plunder their weapons and belongings.

Liripipe hood
No man at this time ever went bare-headed, so any archer without protective headgear would have worn a hat of some kind. A popular style in the 14th century was the hood with a liripipe, a long tubular extension of the tip.

Hood of fine-quality wool

Liripipe – could be wrapped round the neck as a scarf or used to carry valuables

Leather fastening to button up hood at neck

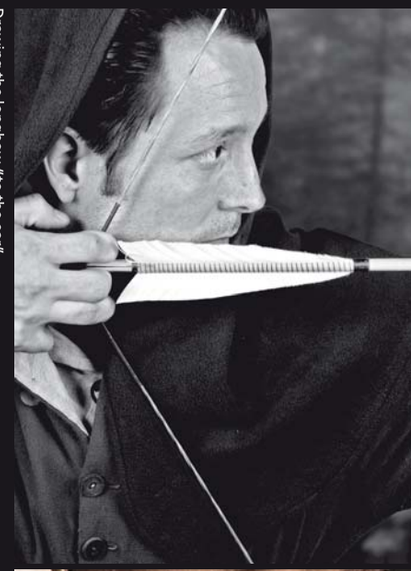
Horn extension to protect tip of the bow and make stringing easier

Bowstring, usually made of hemp

Undershirt
This plain white linen undershirt is of a kind worn by all classes of society in the 14th and 15th centuries.

Barbed arrowhead

Bodkin arrowhead, with square pyramid-shaped point for piercing chainmail



Drawing the longbow "to the ear"



Preparing to fight with a sword and buckler